

Compare that to a more abstract logo (like the Windows logo—it's not a bad logo in itself). You can't really do anything with a logo like that. It just "is".

A contest was announced to select the *best* penguin, and as you've probably guessed, Ewing's penguin was the winner.

1.5 The GPL (General Public License)

If you have installed any Microsoft OS or application, you would have seen the inevitable EULA (End User License Agreement). This is simply a set of rules you agree to (by Pressing *[F8!]*) before you install and use the software. The GPL is a set of terms and conditions that distributors of open source software have to adhere to in order to be GPL-certified. (Any distributor worth his salt would be GPL certified.) The GPL rules have been formed as part of the GNU project, which is an initiative of the Free Software Foundation.



The GPL has codified the essence of open source ideals. It ensures that anyone can modify a GPL-certified program at will and use it. If the modified program is made available for public distribution, then the modified code has to be given to the program user. This is one of the core elements of open source.

The following excerpts from the GPL should help put things in perspective:

The licenses for most software are designed to take away your freedom to share and change it. By contrast, the GNU General Public License is intended to guarantee your freedom to share and change free software—to make sure the software is free for all its users. This General Public License applies to most of the Free Software Foundation's software and to any other